Causes of Hepatitis

- Acute inflammation of the liver due to infection
- Inflammation of the bile duct
- Obstruction of the bile duct
- Hemolytic anemia

Symptoms of Hepatitis

- nausea and vomiting
- high fever
- dark colored urine
- loss of appetite
- pale colored stool
- abdominal pain (especially in the liver region) weakness and fatigue
- weight loss
- ascites

Principles of the Diet

A high protein, high carbohydrate and moderate fat diet is recommended. Small, attractive meals at regular intervals are better tolerated. Over feeding should be avoided.

Dietary Management

Energy: Increased energy intake. A liberal intake of carbohydrates and fat as tolerated is required to reduce protein catabolism. Initially liquid, soft bland diet should be given.

Proteins: For the liver cells to regenerate, an adequate supply of proteins is needed. Protein requirements vary according to the severity of the disease. With severe hepatitis, 40g, while in mild hepatitis 60- 80g of protein is permitted.

Fats: Fats make the food more palatable and increase caloric intake. In severe cases 20g and in moderate cases 20-30g of fat is recommended.

Carbohydrates: High carbohydrate content in the diet is essential to supply enough calories

Vitamins: They are essential to regenerate liver cells. Vitamin C, vitamin K and B complex are essential to meet the daily needs.

Minerals: Oral feeds of fruit juice, vegetables and meat soup with added salt are given orally to maintain the electrolyte balance.

Sodium: If oedema or ascites is present then restrict sodium to 500 mg to 1000 mg. Fluid intake may be limited.

Dietary Guidelines

Foods to be included	Foods to be avoided
Cereal porridge, double cooked rice, soups, Milk, butter milk, Roots and tubers -boiled tapioca, potato and sweet potato, Fruit juices and light custard	Meat, fish, egg, Whole milk and cream, Processed foods -papads, chutneys, pickles, Sweet preparations, bakery products, Dried fruits and nuts, Condiments and spices

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